Sure enough, he wasn't the only target. Firas Khatib, a reporter for the BBC's Arabic service, was attacked during a live shot outside Sderot by an assailant who called him a "son of a whore" and knocked him out of the frame. Yonit Levi, one of the lead anchors for Channel 2, received countless death threats for her perceived "left-wing" views. Never mind that Levi did nothing to earn that ugliest of Israeli epithets—she never criticized the war, and even co-wrote a column afterwards that sympathetically explained why the Israeli media devoted so little attention to the suffering in Gaza. "When your child is spending their summer vacation running to find shelter… one has limited emotional capacity to see what is happening to the children on the other side," she wrote.[30]

Amnon Abramovich, another well-known figure on Channel 2, was attacked at the network's makeshift wartime studio outside the defense ministry on 29 July by a mob chanting "traitor" and "terrorist". Abramovich, unlike Levi, really is a left-wing commentator. But he is also a decorated combat veteran who suffered severe burns during the Yom Kippur War. The scars are visible to this day. No matter—the Tel Aviv police chief had to whisk Abramovich away from the angry crowds in his official car.

It was easier for foreigners, though the mood was hardly welcoming. Interviewees routinely asked me if I was Jewish, a kind of overt tribalism I rarely encountered in years of reporting from around the region. "Jewish or Arab? Because I won't talk to Arabs," one elderly woman warned on a leafy residential street in Ashkelon.

Nor were journalists the only ones targeted for their views. Orna Banai, an actress and comedian, was fired from her job as the spokeswoman for a cruise company after she expressed sympathy for Palestinians. Hanoch Sheinman, a law professor at Bar-Ilan University, decided to revise his exam schedule because of the security situation. He emailed his students about the changes, and opened his letter by wishing that "that you, your families and those dear to you are not among the hundreds of people that were killed, the thousands wounded, or the tens of thousands whose homes were destroyed."

It was a clear, if understated, expression of sympathy for both sides in the conflict—no homes were destroyed in Israel, and the casualties numbered in the dozens. The dean of the law school quickly pronounced himself